

Be Indian

Net on the move

Mobile phone subscribers who do not own WAP enabled handsets can now access the Web, provided they are using the services of Bharti Telecom.

This service provider plans to introduce SIM (subscriber

identification module) cards with a Net browser installed in them. Installing the soft-



ware called the Wireless Internet Browser (WIB) that lets you

browse the Net would mean that a mobile phone

subscriber could have access to the Internet even if s/he does not have a WAP-enabled phone. This development will give users of Bharti's mobile service the ability to surf the Net while on the move. The SIM toolkit comes from SmartTrust of Finland.

ATi to launch 5 chipsets

ATi Technologies, one of the world's leading graphics chip companies, is looking to recharge itself with a leap into the risky market of the PC chipsets. By the middle of 2002, ATi will have five Radeon IGP integrated chipsets with a graphics core based on ATi's standalone Radeon graphics processor.

Chipsets connect a PC's processor with other system-level components such as memory and input/output controllers. PC manufacturers have increasingly looked

at integrated chipsets, which combine a chipset with a graphics and sound processor, to cut costs for low-end PCs.

ATi's foray comes after the entry of rival nVidia into the arena of stand-alone graphics processors. So far, integrated graphics processors have made it into the 810 and 830 chipsets, and nVidia released its nForce integrated chipset. Motherboards with integrated chipsets will not only make graphics cheaper, but help set an acceptable graphics standard.

Price is a major driving factor in the integrated chipset market, which might account for about half of all PC graphics chips in the foreseeable future. ATi forecasts that 60 to 70 per cent of graphics processors will go into integrated chipsets by the year 2006.

The new chipsets will work only with DDR (double-data rate) memory, another sign that the PC market is standardising on DDR rather than the low-end SDRAM and the high-end Rambus memory.

quoteworthy

"This is hard to believe, It has grown all by itself"
— DivX creator Jerome Rota

"It's a bit like being a bank robber caught on videotape..."
— Larry Ellison, Oracle CEO, on the US Department of Justice's proposed settlement of antitrust case against Microsoft

"If you legally acquire music, you need to have the right to manage it on all other devices that you own."
— Steve Jobs, accepting the Grammy awarded to Apple for Outstanding Technical Contribution to the music industry and recording field

snapshot

2.5
billion hours were wasted last year as people waited for pages to download

Source: www.internetstats.com

tomorrow's technology

Blu-ray: New-age storage

Nine companies, namely, Hitachi, LG, Matsushita, Pioneer, Philips, Samsung, Sharp, Sony, and Thomson have developed a 30 GB single sided single layer disc called Blu-ray. The technology incorporates a short wavelength 405 nm blue-violet laser to record, rewrite and playback data from the disc. This high fidelity disc can store up to two hours of

digital high-definition video or 13 hours of TV quality video. The video is recorded in the MPEG2 format and the audio can be recorded in AC3, MPEG1 layer-2, or in any other format of your choice. A simple optical disk cartridge protects the optical disc's recording surface from dust and fingerprints.

Toshiba, in fact, has gone



ahead and unveiled a next-generation storage disc of 110 GB capacity based on the Blu-ray disc technology. The new twin sided DVDs incorporate double layer

construction that enables more data packaging onto the discs.

The companies are planning to create large storage discs by making use of multiple layers and both sides of the disc. The creators of Blu-ray are also planning to manufacture devices that can make full use of the storage capacity of these discs.